

La Madeleine's Tomato-Basil Soup

4 cups tomatoes, peeled, cored and chopped, or canned whole tomatoes, crushed

4 cups tomato juice or part tomato and part vegetable juice or chicken stock

14 washed fresh basil leaves

1 cup heavy cream (Can be replaced w/fat free evaporated milk to make a lighter version)

1/4 pound sweet, unsalted butter

Salt to taste

1/4 teaspoon cracked black pepper

Combine tomatoes, juice/and or stock in saucepan. Simmer 30 minutes. Puree, along with the basil leaves, in small batches, in blender, food processor (or better yet, one of those handy hand-held food blenders, right in the cooking pan). Return to saucepan and add cream and butter, while stirring, over low heat. Garnish with basil leaves and serve with your favorite bread.